Bodo Cultural Heritage: Haba

Category: CUSTOM | Region: Assam | Status: needs_check

Bibliographic Citation & Provenance:

The Kacháris (Sidney Endle, 1911); Bodo Sahitya Sabha socio-cultural records

Narrative & Cultural Documentation:

Haba denotes marriage in the Bodo language and encompasses rich, equitable social traditions that historically avoided child marriage and dowry oppression. Traditional Bodo unions are negotiated by village elders and family representatives through formalized visits involving offerings of betel nuts (Goi-Pathwi) and rice refreshments. The definitive, sacred ritual of a Bodo wedding is the Hathasuni, in which the bride and bridegroom publicly share a consecrated meal of cooked rice and chicken or pork prepared by the bride, formally sealing their lifelong bond in the presence of relatives and village witnesses. Historically, forms of reciprocal service marriage (Ghar-Jiya) also existed, allowing men of humble means to marry with dignity.